Kareem Haggag

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CONTACT INFORMATION

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EMPLOYMENT

UCLA Anderson School of Management
Behavioral Decision Making
Associate Professor — July 2024 - Present
Assistant Professor — July 2021 - June 2024

Carnegie Mellon University
Social and Decision Sciences Department
Assistant Professor — January 2017 - June 2021

Yale University
IPA - Financial Inclusion Program
Postdoctoral Fellow — July - December 2016

EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Booth School of Business
Ph.D. in Economics — 2010 - 2016

University of Tennessee
B.A. in Economics — 2004 - 2008

VISITS

Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis
Visiting Scholar, Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Institute — Fall 2025

Einaudi Institute for Economics and Finance
Visiting Scholar — Winter 2025

Northwestern University, Kellogg School of Management
Visiting Scholar, Finance Department — Fall 2019

AFFILIATIONS

National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) — Faculty Research Fellow
California Center for Population Research (CCPR) — Faculty Affiliate
J-PAL Middle East & North Africa — Invited Researcher
Behavior Change for Good Initiative (BCFG) — Affiliated Scientist
NABE, Behavioral Economics Roundtable — Co-Chair

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral Economics, Political Economy, Inequality, Applied Microeconomics

Publications

1. **Default Tips** (Kareem Haggag and Giovanni Paci)
   American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, 2014, 6(3): 1-19.
   [Lead Article]
   Press: Bloomberg, NPR Morning Edition, Boston Globe, Science (Editors' Choice)

2. **Learning By Driving: Productivity Improvements by New York City Taxi Drivers** (Kareem Haggag, Brian McManus, and Giovanni Paci)
   American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, 2017, 9(1): 70-95.

3. **Attribution Bias in Consumer Choice** (Kareem Haggag, Devin G. Pope, Kinsey B. Bryant-Lees, and Maarten W. Bos)
   Review of Economic Studies, 2019, 86(5): 2136-2183.
   Press: Choiceology

4. **Blue Porches: Finding the Limits of External Validity of the Endowment Effect** (Gharad Bryan, Matthew Grant, Kareem Haggag, Dean Karlan, Meredith Startz, and Chris Udry)
   Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, 2020, 176: 269-271.

5. **Attribution Bias in Major Decisions: Evidence from the United States Military Academy** (Kareem Haggag, Richard W. Patterson, Nolan G. Pope, and Aaron Feudo)
   Journal of Public Economics, 2021, 200: 104445.
   Press: NPR Morning Edition (Hidden Brain), Washington Post

6. **The Long-Run Effects of School Racial Diversity on Political Identity** (Stephen B. Billings, Eric Chyn, and Kareem Haggag)
   American Economic Review: Insights, 2021, 3(3): 267-284.
   [Lead Article]
   Press: Washington Post

7. **Racial Disparities in Voting Wait Times: Evidence from Smartphone Data** (M. Keith Chen, Kareem Haggag, Devin G. Pope, and Ryne Rohla)
   Review of Economics and Statistics, 2022, 104(6): 1341-1350.
   Press: Washington Post Op-Ed, Scientific American, New York Times

8. **Moved to Vote: The Long-Run Effects of Neighborhoods on Political Participation** (Eric Chyn and Kareem Haggag)
   Review of Economics and Statistics, 2023, 105(6): 1596–1605.

9. **Flexible Pay and Labor Supply: Evidence from Uber's Instant Pay** (Keith Chen, Katherine Feinerman, and Kareem Haggag)
   Management Science, 2026, 72(6): 4816–4835.
   Press: Bloomberg

10. **The Effects of Racial Segregation on Intergenerational Mobility: Evidence from Historical Railroad Placement** (Eric Chyn, Kareem Haggag, and Bryan Stuart)
    American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, 2026, 18(2): 34-60.
    Press: NBER Reporter (December 2023), Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia (Research in Focus)

11. **Inaccurate Statistical Discrimination: An Identification Problem** (J. Aislinn Bohren, Kareem Haggag, Alex Imas, and Devin G. Pope)
Review of Economics and Statistics, 2025, 107(3): 605–620.
Press: Freakonomics

12. **The Value of a Higher ACT Exam Score** (Kareem Haggag, Emily Leslie, Devin Pope, and Nolan Pope)
Forthcoming at **Journal of Human Resources**

13. **Inequality and Racial Backlash: Evidence from the Reconstruction Era and the Freedmen's Bureau** (Eric Chyn, Kareem Haggag, and Bryan Stuart)
American Economic Review, 2026, 116(11): 4158–4202.

Working Papers

14. **Ideology in Government: Evidence from the Office of Indian Affairs and the Assimilation Era** (Eric Chyn, Kareem Haggag, and Christian Maruthiah), *NBER Working Paper* 34415, October 2026.

15. **The Persistence of Power: How Family Origins Shape Political Representation and Policy** (Eric Chyn, Katherine Cohen, Kareem Haggag, and Bryan Stuart), *NBER Working Paper* 35180, August 2026.

16. **Selection and Incentives in Microequity Contracts: Evidence from a Field Experiment** (Kareem Haggag and Adam Osman)
Accepted at **Journal of Development Economics**, Pre-Results Review as "Expanding Access to Finance through Micro-Equity."

Other Work Experience

Innovations for Poverty Action June 2008 - July 2010
Project Associate

Professional Activities

Russell Sage Foundation Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics (2014)

Referee Service:
American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, *American Economic Review*, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Econometrica*, *Economic Journal*, *Economica*, *Economics of Education Review*,*European Economic Review*, *Experimental Economics*, *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization*, *Journal of the European Economic Association*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management, Journal of Political Economy*, *Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Labour Economics*, *Management Science*, *Marketing Science*, *Organizational Behavior and Human Decision Processes*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *RAND Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economic Studies*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Science Advances*, *Early Career Behavioral Economics Conference*, *BDRM Conference*, *National Tax Association Annual Conference*, *Society for Judgment and Decision Making Conference*, *Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics Conference*, *Africa Meeting of the Econometric Society*, *National Science Foundation*, *JPAL-North America Grants*

Excellence in Refereeing Award 2018 & 2020, *American Economic Review*
Excellence in Refereeing Award 2021 & 2022, *American Economic Review: Insights*

Teaching

Behavioral Economics Winter '22; Spring '23, '24, '25, '26; Fall '26
UCLA Anderson: MGMT 203-01 (FTMBA) and 203-02 (FEMBA)

Behavioral Economics Spring '26
UCLA Anderson: MGMT 260 (PhD)

Causal Inference in the Field Spring '18, '19, '20, '21
CMU: SDS 88-252 (Undergraduate)

Behavioral Economics of Poverty and Development Spring '18, '19, '20, '21
CMU: SDS 88-366 (Undergraduate) & PPP 90-892 (Master's)

Invited Presentations

2026: UC-Berkeley (Political Science), USC Marshall (Economics and Finance), UC-Riverside (Political Science), UC-Davis (Economics)

2025: University of Zurich (Economics), Norwegian School of Economics (FAIR), Political Economy of Geographic Polarization in Rich Democracies Conference (Stanford), Federal Reserve Bank of Minneapolis (Opportunity and Inclusive Growth Institute), Oxford University (Economics), London School of Economics (Economics), University of Nebraska (Economics)

2024: Harvard University (Political Economy), UC-Berkeley (Economics), UC-Berkeley Haas (Real Estate), UCSD Rady (Economics). University of Pittsburgh (Economics), Carnegie Mellon University (SDS), Johns Hopkins University Carey Business School (Economics), UC-Davis (Economics & ARE), University of Southern California (PIPE), Australian National University (Economics), NBER Summer Institute, Race, Racism, and Structural Inequality Conference (Duke), AALIMS Conference on the Political Economy of the Muslim World (Harvard), Behavioral Decision Research in Management Conference (UChicago), Los Angeles Experiments Conference (Caltech), Historical Political Economy Conference (USC), NABE Tech Economics Conference, Institutional Barriers to Equity Workshop (Monash University), Econometric Society Australasian Meeting 2024

2023: Opportunity Insights (Harvard), Stanford GSB (Political Economy), Society for Judgment and Decision Making Conference

2022: Duke University (Economics), New York University (Identities & Ideologies Project), UPenn - Wharton (Marketing), Consumer Financial Protection Bureau, Loyola Marymount University (Economics), Brown University (Economics), University of Chicago (Harris), UCLA (CCPR)

2021: Columbia Business School (Management), New York University (Wagner), Pomona College (Economics), UC-Riverside (Economics), University of Chicago (HCEO, Conference on New Approaches to Discrimination Research), Dalhousie University (Economics)

2020: Stanford University (Economics), Yale School of Management (Economics), Harvard Business School (NOM), Berkeley-UChicago (Joint Behavioral Economics Workshop), UCLA Anderson (BDM), UCLA Anderson (Marketing), University of Delaware (Economics), Carnegie Mellon University (CBDR), Tilburg University

(Symposium on Social Cohesion in Ethnically Diverse Societies), Southern Economic Association Annual Meetings

2019: Brown University (Economics), University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (Economics), University of Munich (Economics)

2018: Behavioral Decision Research in Management Conference (HBS)

2017: University of Pittsburgh (Economics), Yale University (Behavioral Science), Penn-CMU Roybal Center Retreat

2016: Carnegie Mellon University (SDS), Cornell University (Economics), Early Career Behavioral Economics Conference (Bonn, Germany), SITE Experimental Conference (Stanford), University of California - San Diego (Rady), University of Oregon (Economics), University of Tennessee (Economics)

2013: 9th Annual Whitebox Advisors Graduate Student Conference (Yale SOM)

Grants and Fellowships

Fund for Innovation in Development (€1,500,000) for "*Estimating the Human Costs of Debtor Prisons*"	2025-2027
UCLA Academic Senate Faculty Research Grant	2025
PWC Faculty Excellence in Research Award	2024
JPAL MENA / Egypt Impact Lab Grant ($74,353) for "*Estimating the Social Costs of Debtor Prisons" (Pilot)*	2024
California Center for Population Research Course Release	2023
UCLA Fink Center Faculty Research Grant ($10,000)	2023
USAID Development Innovations Ventures Grant ($524,466) for "*Expanding Access to Finance Through Micro-Equity"*	2019 - 2023
Agency of Healthcare Research and Quality T32 Training Fellowship	2015-2016
Russell Sage Foundation Small Grant in Behavioral Economics	2013